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Of the fifty-three pictures I appeared in, thirty-one were made before the war and twenty-two after the war. In addition to *Kings Row* and *Knute Rockne—All American*, I'm especially proud of several of the postwar pictures, particularly *The Voice of the Turtle, John Loves Mary, The Hasty Heart*, and *The Winning Team*, in which I played the great baseball player, Grover Cleveland Alexander.

But enormous change was coming to Hollywood after the war, and a lot of it wasn't for the good.

When I arrived there in my Nash convertible in 1937, there were seven major studios in Hollywood. Each had a huge production lot dominated by barn-like soundstages where the interior scenes of movies were shot, a make-believe New York City neighborhood, and a western town with false-fronted saloons and a dusty main street for exterior shots. The studios also owned large ranches in the San Fernando Valley where western and outdoor movies were filmed.

In those days Hollywood was run a lot like an old-fashioned candy store: You cooked it in the back and sold it in the front. Each studio had a big stable of contract actors, writers, directors, musicians, and producers who turned out the pictures, and a nationwide chain of theaters where the pictures were exhibited. The studio was like an assembly line that was entrusted to keep a steady stream of pictures flowing to the theaters.

This system turned out many of the best pictures ever made. Each studio was like a big family. You belonged to Warner Brothers or MGM or Paramount and your associates and friends were mostly other performers and writers and directors from your studio. Sometimes we had family fights,